

An estimated 17% textile waste ends up in landfills; the industry contributes 8-10% to the total greenhouse gas emissions.

India is the sixth-largest textile exporter. The sector contributes 2.3% to GDP, 13% to industrial production and 12% to exports. The domestic textile industry accounts for a 4.5% share of global trade, with the US and the EU accounting for 47% of India's textile and apparel imports. Approximately 7.8 million tonnes or 8.5% of global textile waste is accumulated in India every year, according to a report by IDH and Sattva Consulting.

The demand for man-made fibre textiles, which includes materials such as polyester, acrylic, viscose fibre and modal, has been increasing globally, as a substitute for cotton amidst changes in global fashion trends. At present, man-made fibre dominates global textile fibre consumption with a 72% share.

Analysts point out to the damage caused by polyester and nylon. "Large-scale use of synthetic fibres contributes significantly to Scope 3 emissions and microplastic pollution," says Thekkevariath.

SUSTAINABILITY AND INNOVATION

The government's National Technical Textiles Mission, launched with a ₹1,480 crore outlay in 2020, aims to push technical textiles across flagship programmes and strategic sectors.

"Rebates for renewable energy, low-carbon process tech and ETP/ ZLD (effluent textile plants/zero liquid discharge) in textile mills could incentivise sustainable practices," says Thekkevariath.

As the government pushes for decarbonisation, companies have also stepped up their ESG efforts. Raymond Ltd has introduced dope-dyed wool to replace traditional white polyester wool, cutting dye use and slashing energy consumption. The company reduced its Scope 1 emissions by 1.84% in FY24.

Reliance Retail, which operates brands such as Reliance Trends and Ajio, is fully committed to reducing emissions. The



TEXTILE POLLUTION

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